

groundcover

Observability · eBPF, Bring-Your-Own-Cloud · Tel Aviv · Boston · San Francisco; founded 2021 · Private (~\$500M reported; \$100M Series C, Jul 2026)

groundcover, the Tel Aviv observability company that says it wants to replace Datadog, announced a \$100M Series C led by One Peak on 29 July, with Morgan Stanley Expansion Capital joining. Total funding is \$160M; Calcalist puts the valuation at about \$500M, roughly four times the last round (reported).

70

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

TGR Haas F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Zeev Ventures, Angular Ventures, Heavybit and Jibe returned; the \$35M Series B, led by Zeev, closed in April 2025. Over the past year the company tripled annual recurring revenue, doubled headcount to about 140, roughly 80 in Israel and the rest in Boston and San Francisco, and passed 250 paying customers, startups to Fortune 5 enterprises. Its platform captures telemetry with eBPF inside the customer's own cloud, so nothing leaves the environment. Founders Shahar Azulay and Yechezkel Rabinovich served together in the cyber unit of Israel's Prime Minister's Office.

Observability is on the grid but thinly: Splunk sits with McLaren through Cisco and Dynatrace at Racing Bulls, and the rest of the field runs the same telemetry pipelines without a named partner. A challenger that needs to be seen beside the incumbents, and whose whole pitch is keeping sensitive data inside the customer's walls, has a story Formula 1 tells better than any conference.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 29 July with a doubled team to feed and a US push from Boston and San Francisco. Austin (late October) and Las Vegas (November) fall inside the window; teams settle 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$100M

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\$35M

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

TGR Haas F1 Team ♦ RECOMMENDED	PRIME LANE	documented open category: observability
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Cisco, Google Cloud, Splunk
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	Microsoft
Oracle Red Bull Racing	TAKEN	Oracle

BOTTOM LINE

A \$100M Series C led by One Peak, tripled ARR and a doubled team give groundcover the budget and the motive to be seen beside Splunk and Dynatrace; Haas offers an open observability lane at a privateer's price. Scale and the absence of a marketing officer hold the score at 70.

FUNDING EVENT

CATEGORY PRECEDENT

CHALLENGER BRAND

DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY TGR HAAS F1 TEAM

Haas is the lean American privateer: Kannapolis base, Banbury forward base, Toyota Gazoo Racing as title partner from 2026, and a technology roster of Mphasis for services, CommScope and Ruckus for networking, Infobip for messaging. It has no observability partner, so Official Observability Partner is clean, and Mphasis is a services channel rather than a rival. A small engineering team running cloud and trackside systems under a cost cap is the customer groundcover's in-your-own-cloud model was built for.

VALUE TO TGR HAAS F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. groundcover deploys inside Haas's own cloud and Kubernetes estate and captures logs, metrics and traces with eBPF, without instrumenting each application: the pipelines that carry car data from the garage to Kannapolis and Banbury, the simulation services, the race-weekend tooling. Engineers get one view of what is slow or failing between sessions, and no telemetry leaves the team's environment.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Observability Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, covering the US expansion and a possible next round. Estimated \$1.5-3M a year, part in platform licences. Scope: car and garage placement, a 'what the grid runs on' engineering content series, Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for platform-engineering buyers, a Haas reference case.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Shahar Azulay

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, GROUNDCOVER · VERIFIED

Azulay co-founded groundcover in 2021 with CTO Yechezkel Rabinovich after a machine-learning role at Apple (reported); he fronts every raise and a first sponsorship is his call. Path: Chris Churilo, VP Marketing (San Francisco), and Ran Ziskovich, VP Finance (reported). No chief marketing or financial officer is titled.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with Datadog and the open lane.

“Shahar, you have said you want to replace Datadog. Datadog is not on the grid, Splunk and Dynatrace are, and Haas has no observability partner. 25 minutes before Austin to see what a challenger's seat costs?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Round announced 29 Jul; Monza, Austin and Las Vegas in the window.	CAPACITY 13 / 20 \$100M raise, \$160M total, ~\$500M reported; 140 staff.	BRAND FIT 13 / 20 Developer-facing B2B brand; platform-engineering audience.	URGENCY 12 / 20 US push and doubled team; no hard deadline.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: in-your-own-cloud observability of a small team's estate.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

SCALE \$160M raised, about \$500M reported value and 140 staff; a Formula 1 fee is a large share of a challenger's marketing budget. **Counter:** Part-pay in licences and step fees up with the next round.

NO MARKETING OFFICER Marketing is led at VP level from San Francisco; a sponsorship has no natural owner below the CEO. **Counter:** Pitch to Azulay directly with Churilo on the call; frame the deal as the US launch campaign.

SOURCES — 16 OF 16 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/r19aupvrme
- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260729686071/en/groundcover-Raises-\$100-Million-Series-C-to-Create-the-Observability-Platform-Built-for-the-AI-Era